

**CURRICULUM VITAE**

Joy Lee-Shi

jleeshi@outlook.com

Additional Languages: Mandarin (Conversational), Spanish (Basic Conversational)

**EDUCATION**

---

- 2023 – 2025     **Master of Arts, Experimental Psychology (History, Quantitative, Theoretical Specialization)**  
Simon Fraser University (SFU), Burnaby, BC, Canada  
Thesis: *Adversity and Trauma: Examining and Elaborating the Hybrid Model of Stress Response as Applied to Belizean Contexts*  
Supervisor: Dr. Robert G. Ley
- 2018 – 2022     **Bachelor of Arts, Psychology (Honours with Distinction)**  
Simon Fraser University (SFU), Burnaby  
Thesis: *Differences in Flow State and Flow Disposition in Jazz vs. Classical Musicians and their Practice*  
Supervisor: Dr. Robert G. Ley
- 2016 – 2018     **Associate of Science, Pure Mathematics**  
St. John's College Junior College (SJCJC), Belize

**CERTIFICATES / LICENSES**

---

- 07/2025     **Teaching License**, Level: Secondary [Education] – Counselling, Belize  
Ministry of Education, Expires 07/2027, ID: BZ-2025-00046
- 05/2025     **Peer Navigator** (for providing HIV Voluntary Counselling), GOJoven  
Belize Alumni Association (GOBelize)
- 2024, 2020     **TCPS 2: CORE** (Tri-Council Policy Statement: Ethical Conduct for  
Research Involving Humans Course on Research Ethics)

**SCHOLARSHIPS, AWARDS AND GRANTS**

---

- 2025     Selected Author, The Annual Celebration of SFU Authors 2024, SFU
- 2023 – 2024     Graduate Fellowship, SFU (\$14,000 CAD)
- 2023 – 2024     Special Graduate Entrance Scholarship, SFU (\$5,000 CAD)
- 2024     Honourable Mention Winner for Best Psychology Data Blitz Presentation,  
Criminal Minds 2024 – An Interdisciplinary Conference, SFU
- 2022, 2020     President's Honour Roll, SFU
- 2022, 2020,  
2019     Dean's Honour Roll, SFU
- 2021     Undergraduate Open Scholarship, SFU (\$990 CAD)
- 2016 – 2018     Dean's Honour List, SJCJC
- 2016     National 1<sup>st</sup> Place in Mathematics, Association of Tertiary Level  
Institutions in Belize (ATLIB)

## PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

---

- 02/2026 – 04/2026 **Conference Organizer**, St John's College - University, Emerging Scholars Conference
- 08/2025 – 12/2025 **Special Education Resource Teacher**, Itz'at STEAM Academy, Belize
- Curated evidence-based materials for student accommodations
  - Develop and deliver a course, Student Inclusion & Learning, to 1st/2nd years (6 classrooms), using evidence-based frameworks
- 08/2024 – Present **Peer Reviewer**, Journal of Belizean Research
- 03/2024 – 10/2025 **Graduate Reviewer**, SFU, Undergraduate Journal of Psychology
- 01/2025 – 05/2025 **Conference Organizer**, SFU, Psychological Methods in Action: PSYC 201W Spring Conference
- 07/2024 – 04/2025 **Experimental Psychology Departmental Representative**, SFU, Psychology Graduate Caucus

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

---

- 07/2026 – Present **Freelance Statistical Analyst**, Belize
- Conduct analyses for PhD research on Child Protective Services (CPS) Workers' experiences with stress, burnout, and trauma
- 09/2025 – Present **Co-Author & Statistical Analyst**, Belize National Association of Social Workers (BNASW), Belize
- Lead the design, analysis, and report writing for a nationwide needs assessment survey
- 07/2025 – Present **Co-Author & Statistical Analyst**, Indigenous Peoples Participation in Higher Education Project (IPinHE) – Belizean Branch  
Principal Investigator: Dr. Filiberto Penados
- Conducted statistical analyses and produced a 77-page report
- 2022 – 2023 **Literature Review Assistant**, Dr. Robert G. Ley
- Conducted scoping reviews in support of forensic clinical psychological expert witness evaluations and reports
- 2021 – 2023 **Research Assistant**, SFU, Attention Lab  
Lab Director: Dr. Thomas Spalek
- Lead participant intake and debriefing for Evaluative Space Model and Flanker studies
- 2020 – 2023 **Research Assistant**, SFU, Measurement and Modelling Lab  
Lab Director: Dr. Rachel T. Fouladi
- Transcribed 40+ audio-recorded interviews (30–80 minutes each)
  - Supported 3 Master's students' projects through qualitative coding and thematic analysis of interview data using NVivo and Excel
- 2022 – 2023 **Researcher**, <https://jls-bz.github.io/>  
Topic: *Text-Based Big-Data Analyses on Discussions of Dissociation*

- Developed Python / R scripts to web-scrape and clean Reddit posts
- Using Natural Language Processing tools, analyzed text-based big-data via Topic Modelling with Term-Frequency Inverse Document Frequency and Latent Dirichlet Allocation

### BOOKS & BOOK CHAPTERS [2]

---

2. Young, L., & **Lee-Shi, J.** (2026). *Psychological First Aid for Young Peers: A Handbook*. Belize City Lions Club Mental Health Committee.
1. **Lee-Shi, J.** (2024). In the Zone: Understanding the Mystique of Flow. In D. Lacey & **J. Lee-Shi** (Eds.), *Beautiful Belize City* (pp. 36-37). Yaoling Lee.

### PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS [3]

---

3. Young, L., & **Lee-Shi, J.** (accepted). Boots on the Ground, Cracks in the System: BDF Mental Health and Wellbeing. *Keeping Independence Alive: Belize @45*.
2. Penados, F., Rosado, L., Tzib, D., **Lee-Shi, J.**, & Gonzalez, G. N. (2026). Indigenous Peoples Participation in Higher Education in Belize: Present Realities and its Implications for Policy and Practice. *Ichan Tecolotl*, 400.  
<https://ichan.ciesas.edu.mx/indigenous-peoples-participation-in-higher-education-in-belize-present-realities-and-its-implication-for-policy-and-practice/>
1. **Lee-Shi, J.**, & Ley, R. G. (2022). A Critique of the Dispositional Flow Scale-2 (DFS-2) and Flow State Scale-2 (FSS-2). *Frontiers in Psychology*, 13.  
<https://www.frontiersin.org/articles/10.3389/fpsyg.2022.992813>

### CONFERENCES & SYMPOSIUMS [13]

---

13. Vairez, M., & **Lee-Shi, J.** (2026, September). *Grit, Mental Health, and Pandemic Related Adversity Among Adolescents in Belize*. The Belize-Mexico Binational Seminar, Belize.
12. Vairez, M., & **Lee-Shi, J.** (2026, September). *Validating the Short Grit Scale (Grit-S) with a Sample of Adolescents in Belize*. The Belize-Mexico Binational Seminar, Belize.
11. Young, L., & **Lee-Shi, J.** (2026, September). *Boots on the Ground, Cracks in the System: BDF Mental Health and Wellbeing*. Keeping Independence Alive: Belize @45, Belize Policy Research Institute (BELPRI), Belize.
10. Penados, F., Rosado, L., **Lee-Shi, J.**, Tzib, D., & Gonzalez, N. G. (2025, October). *Indigenous Peoples' Participation in Higher Education in Belize: Present Realities and its Implications for Policy and Practice* [Oral Presentation]. Belize KULCHA Symposium, Heritage Education Network, Belize.
9. Penados, F., Rosado, L., **Lee-Shi, J.**, & Tzib, D. (2025, September). *Indigenous Peoples in Higher Education: A Diagnostic – Belize* [Oral Presentation]. Second General Meeting, Ciencia y Tecnologia, International Development Research Centre, Costa Rica.

8. **Lee-Shi, J., & Ley, R. G.** (2025, May). *From Adversity to Trauma: Examining and Elaborating the Hybrid Model of Stress Response as Applied to Belizean Contexts* [Paper presentation, Symposium]. Inaugural Conference on Critical Social Justice in Psychology, Vancouver, BC, Canada.
7. **Lee-Shi, J., & Ley, R. G.** (2025, April). *The Double-Edged Sword of Social Support: Protective and Risk Factors in Trauma Recovery in Belize* [Oral presentation]. 22<sup>nd</sup> Hawai'i International Summit on Preventing, Assessing & Treating Trauma Across the Lifespan, Hawaii, USA.
6. **Lee-Shi, J., & Wong, M.** (2024, May). *Cognitive Emotion Regulation in Depression: Potential Insights from Natural Language Processing Analyses*. [Poster presentation]. Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies: Annual Student Research Symposium (ABCT), Virtual Conference.
5. **Lee-Shi, J., & Fouladi, R. T.** (2024, April). *Defining Resilience Beyond Trauma and Violence in Belizean Communities*. [Poster presentation]. Justice, Reconciliation, Equity, Diversity, Accessibility, and Inclusion (JEDAI) Research Fair, Burnaby, BC, Canada.
4. **Lee-Shi, J.** (2024, March). *Exploring the Psychology of Gang Involvement and Its Impact on the Community*. [Data Blitz presentation]. 2024 Criminal Minds – An Interdisciplinary Conference, Burnaby, BC, Canada.
3. **Lee-Shi, J., & Fouladi, R. T.** (2023, May). *Manual Text Feature and Machine-Learning Analyses on Think-Aloud Concussion Assessment Transcriptions: Who Finds What Confusing?* [Poster presentation]. Connecting Minds Research Conference, Richmond, BC, Canada.
2. **Lee-Shi, J., Ley, R. G., Cox, D., & Sugarman, J.** (2022, June). *A Pilot Study: Differences in Flow State and Flow Disposition in Jazz vs. Classical Musicians and their Practice* [Poster presentation]. Annual Canadian Psychological Association Convention, Calgary, AB, Canada.
1. **Lee-Shi, J., Ley, R. G., Cox, D., & Sugarman, J.** (2022, March). *Differences in Flow State and Flow Disposition in Jazz vs. Classical Musicians and their Practice*. In *Putting On a Show: Sports and Music* [Symposium]. Simon Fraser University Undergraduate Research Symposium, Burnaby, BC, Canada.

#### **OTHER PRESENTATIONS [3]**

---

3. **Penados, F., Rosado, L., Tzib, D., & Lee-Shi, J.** (2026, June). *Indigenous Participation in Higher Education: Key Findings and Recommendations* [Roundtable Presentation]. Galen University, Belize.
2. **Penados, F., Rosado, L., Tzib, D., & Lee-Shi, J.** (2025, October). *Advancing Inclusive Policies for Indigenous Participation in Higher Education: Present Realities and Implications* [Oral Presentation]. Indigenous Resistance Day Lecture and Workshop, University of Belize, Belmopan, Belize.

1. **Lee-Shi, J., Barrett, R., & Aldenhoven, L. M.** (2024, July). *Gender Minorities and Crisis Support in Vancouver: Perceptions and Impacts* [Poster presentation]. Burnaby Pride Festival, Burnaby, BC, Canada.

### CLINICAL TRAINING

---

- |         |                                                                                                          |
|---------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 11/2024 | <b>Stress and Trauma: An Attachment-Based Perspective</b><br>Training by Gordon Neufeld, Ph.D., R. Psych |
| 10/2024 | <b>Trauma-informed Supports for Autism</b><br>Presented by Alexia Stack and Ben Reiman (M.A., BCBAs)     |
| 02/2024 | <b>Indigenous Approaches to Trauma and Wellness</b><br>Training by Karlee Fellner, Ph.D., R. Psych       |

### CLINICAL EXPERIENCE FOR RESEARCH PURPOSES

---

- |             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Summer 2024 | <b>Research Interviewer</b><br><i>Trauma, Coping and Post-traumatic Changes Study in Belize</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Based on Grounded Theory and IPA principles, designed, conducted, and analyzed semi-structured interviews (N = 12, adults, 1-3 hours each), on adversity/trauma, coping, post-stressor changes</li> </ul> <u>Supervisor:</u> Dr. Robert G. Ley |
|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

### CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

---

- |                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 29/08/2026        | <b>Program Co-Facilitator, Peer Advocacy &amp; Leadership:</b><br><i>Psychological First Aid Training for Youth, Belize City Lions Club</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Supervise and co-lead a Psychological First Aid Training workshop</li> </ul>                                                                                              |
| 05/2025 – 10/2025 | <b>Peer Navigator, GOJoven Belize Alumni Association</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Provide HIV testing and pre-/post-test counselling</li> <li>Deliver peer counselling to one client: psychoeducation on stress responses, guidance in identifying coping strategies and sources of stress</li> </ul>                                          |
| 07/2025 – 09/2025 | <b>Program Co-Facilitator, Strong Roots, Brave Voices, META Belize</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Co-led a trauma-focused cognitive behavioural therapy (TF-CBT) group adapted for Belizean adolescents in conflict with the law and experiencing grief and traumatic stress</li> </ul> <u>Facilitator:</u> Azalia G. Larrieu, LCSW, MSW, CCTS-I |
| 01/2024 – 04/2025 | <b>Career Development Mentor in Behaviour Intervention, Metro Vancouver, Canada</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Facilitate discussions on ethical practices, effective client (parent and child) engagement, and career challenges</li> </ul>                                                                                                     |
| 10/2023 – 11/2024 | <b>Senior Behaviour Interventionist, Metro Vancouver, Canada</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |

- Implemented one-on-one ABA intervention plans, to foster adaptive behaviours, communication, social skills, and self-regulation in children (aged 4 – 8) with ASD
- Recruited, supervised, and trained behaviour interventionists

Supervisor: Zoë Liu M.Ed. BCBA

02/2022 – 12/2023 **Behaviour Interventionist**, Metro Vancouver, Canada

- Implemented individualized ABA- and ESDM-based behaviour interventions for children (aged 3 – 12) with ASD and attention disorders.

Supervisors: Zoë Liu, Yvonne Kong, Karla Suarez (M.Ed. BCBAs)

## **ACADEMIC POSITIONS**

---

### **Graduate Level**

Spring 2024 **Invited Guest Lecturer** – PSYC 770 – Proseminar in Personality, SFU  
Instructor: Dr. Robert G. Ley  
Lecture Topic: The Big Five Personality Traits

### **Undergraduate Level**

Fall 2026 **Lecturer (Sessional)**, University of Belize, Belize  
Course: Research Methods

Spring 2026 **Psychology Lecturer (Sessional)**, St John's College – University, Belize  
Courses: Industrial and Organizational Psychology, Behavioral Genetics, Adolescent Development, Neuropsychology, Research in Psychology

Spring 2025, Summer 2024 **Teaching Assistant (TA) and TA Mentor** – PSYC 201W – Introduction to Research Methods in Psychology, SFU

Fall 2024, Spring 2024, Fall 2023 **Teaching Assistant** – PSYC 201W, SFU

## **VOLUNTEERING**

---

2025 – Present, 2012 – 2016 **Belize National Orchestra**, Belize  
 Position: Wind Section Mentor, Principal Flautist

## **PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS**

---

09/2025 – Present **Board Member**, Mental Health Association, Belize

2024 – 2025 **Graduate Student Member**, American Psychological Association, Division 56 Trauma Psychology